RUSSIAN REVOLUTION AND USSR UNDER STALIN

UNFINISHED REVOLUTION AFTER 1905 → WAR-TO-COLLAPSE CHAIN → DUAL-POWER MECHANISM → FEBRUARY VERSUS OCTOBER → PROVISIONAL GOVERNMENT FAILURE → BOLSHEVIK CONSOLIDATION TOOLKIT

Read the thick cyan rail from Stage 00 to the final core synthesis. Each card uses a concept-appropriate structure: the grey E card is optional enrichment only and never repairs missing core content.

◆ PRIMARY CORE FLOW · ◆ SUBORDINATE EXTRA · ★ APPROVAL / REVIEW

CORE BEFORE EXTRA • prior artefacts unchanged • exact same master drives poster and tiles

Approval: FALSE • Pending user review • source generation g4 and all prior artifacts unchanged

00

STAGE 00 UNFINISHED REVOLUTION AFTER 1905

UNFINISHED REVOLUTION AFTER 1905 · DEFEAT BY JAPAN · UNREST AND OCTOBER MANIFESTO · PROMISED BUT FIRST TWO DISSOLVED · STOLYPIN REFORMS REACH TOO FEW · REGIME SURVIVES WITHOUT SOLVING LEGITIMACY · MUST REMEMBER · THE 1905 CRISIS, FEBRUARY AND OCTOBER 1917 REVOLUTIONS, CIVIL

DEFEAT BY JAPAN → unrest and October Manifesto → DUMA → promised but first two dissolved → LAND → Stolypin reforms reach too few → RESULT → regime survives without solving legitimacy → MUST REMEMBER: The 1905 crisis, February and October 1917 revolutions, Civil War, War

CORE CLAIM
- DEFEAT BY JAPAN → unrest and October Manifesto
- DUMA → promised but first two dissolved

MECHANISM
- LAND → Stolypin reforms reach too few
- RESULT → regime survives without solving legitimacy

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- MUST REMEMBER: The 1905 crisis, February and October 1917 revolutions, Civil War, War
- Communism, NEP, Lenin's death and Stalin's consolidation form a process rather than one inevitable Bolshevik event.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Communism, NEP, Lenin's death and Stalin's consolidation form a process rather than one inevitable Bolshevik event.

01

STAGE 01 WAR-TO-COLLAPSE CHAIN

WAR-TO-COLLAPSE CHAIN · OLD WEAKNESS · AUTOCRACY, LAND AND LABOUR CONFLICT · WORLD WAR · DEFEAT, SHORTAGE AND TRANSPORT FAILURE · RIOTS, STRIKES AND MUTINY · 2 MARCH 1917 · NICHOLAS II ABDICATES

OLD WEAKNESS → autocracy, land and labour conflict → WORLD WAR → defeat, shortage and transport failure → PETROGRAD → riots, strikes and mutiny → 2 MARCH 1917 → Nicholas II abdicates

CORE CLAIM
- OLD WEAKNESS → autocracy, land and labour conflict
- WORLD WAR → defeat, shortage and transport failure

MECHANISM
- PETROGRAD → riots, strikes and mutiny
- 2 MARCH 1917 → Nicholas II abdicates

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- OLD WEAKNESS → autocracy, land and labour conflict
- WORLD WAR → defeat, shortage and transport failure

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: WORLD WAR → defeat, shortage and transport failure.

02

STAGE 02 DUAL-POWER MECHANISM

DUAL-POWER MECHANISM · PROVISIONAL GOVERNMENT · FORMAL STATE OFFICE · PETROGRAD SOVIET · SOLDIER AND WORKER LOYALTY · GOVERNMENT DELAYS DECISIONS · AUTHORITY EXISTS IN TWO INCOMPATIBLE CENTRES

CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
PROVISIONAL GOVERNMENT → formal state office	WAR/LAND → government delays decisions	PROVISIONAL GOVERNMENT → formal state office
PETROGRAD SOVIET → soldier and worker loyalty	RESULT → authority exists in two incompatible centres	PETROGRAD SOVIET → soldier and worker loyalty

CORE CLAIM
- PROVISIONAL GOVERNMENT → formal state office
- PETROGRAD SOVIET → soldier and worker loyalty

MECHANISM
- WAR/LAND → government delays decisions
- RESULT → authority exists in two incompatible centres

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- PROVISIONAL GOVERNMENT → formal state office
- PETROGRAD SOVIET → soldier and worker loyalty

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: RESULT → authority exists in two incompatible centres.

03

STAGE 03 FEBRUARY VERSUS OCTOBER

FEBRUARY VERSUS OCTOBER · BROAD UPRISING AND TSARIST COLLAPSE · PREPARED BOLSHEVIK SEIZURE · NICHOLAS ABDICATES · MINISTERS ARRESTED, PARTY TAKES POWER

CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
FEBRUARY → broad uprising and tsarist collapse	FEBRUARY → Nicholas abdicates	FEBRUARY → broad uprising and tsarist collapse
OCTOBER → prepared Bolshevik seizure	OCTOBER → ministers arrested, party takes power	OCTOBER → prepared Bolshevik seizure

CORE CLAIM
- FEBRUARY → broad uprising and tsarist collapse
- OCTOBER → prepared Bolshevik seizure

MECHANISM
- FEBRUARY → Nicholas abdicates
- OCTOBER → ministers arrested, party takes power

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- FEBRUARY → broad uprising and tsarist collapse
- OCTOBER → prepared Bolshevik seizure

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: FEBRUARY → Nicholas abdicates; OCTOBER → ministers arrested, party takes power.

04

STAGE 04 PROVISIONAL GOVERNMENT FAILURE

PROVISIONAL GOVERNMENT FAILURE · WAR CONTINUES · POPULAR SUPPORT FALLS · LAND/ELECTIONS DELAYED · RURAL AND DEMOCRATIC TRUST FALLS · ECONOMIC LEGITIMACY COLLAPSES · BOLSHEVIKS GAIN ORGANISATIONAL PRESTIGE

WAR CONTINUES → popular support falls → LAND/ELECTIONS DELAYED → rural and democratic trust falls → SHORTAGES → economic legitimacy collapses → KORNILOV → Bolsheviks gain organisational prestige

CORE CLAIM
- WAR CONTINUES → popular support falls
- LAND/ELECTIONS DELAYED → rural and democratic trust falls

MECHANISM
- SHORTAGES → economic legitimacy collapses
- KORNILOV → Bolsheviks gain organisational prestige

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- WAR CONTINUES → popular support falls
- LAND/ELECTIONS DELAYED → rural and democratic trust falls

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: LAND/ELECTIONS DELAYED → rural and democratic trust falls.

05

STAGE 05 BOLSHEVIK CONSOLIDATION TOOLKIT

BOLSHEVIK CONSOLIDATION TOOLKIT · LAND AND WORKER MEASURES · EXIT WAR · BREST-LITOVSK, MARCH 1918 · ASSEMBLY DISPERSED, CHEKA AND RED TERROR · CIVIL WAR VICTORY THEN NEP

DECREE → land and worker measures

EXIT WAR → Brest-Litovsk, March 1918 → COERCION → Assembly dispersed, Cheka and Red Terror → SURVIVAL → Civil War victory then NEP

CORE CLAIM
- DECREE → land and worker measures
- EXIT WAR → Brest-Litovsk, March 1918

MECHANISM
- COERCION → Assembly dispersed, Cheka and Red Terror
- SURVIVAL → Civil War victory then NEP

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- DECREE → land and worker measures
- EXIT WAR → Brest-Litovsk, March 1918

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: COERCION → Assembly dispersed, Cheka and Red Terror.

06

STAGE 06 WHY THE REDS WON

WHY THE REDS WON · LENIN AND TROTSKY FIRMER · CENTRAL RUSSIAN CORE CONTROLLED · WHITES DIVIDED IN AIM · REDS CLAIM DEFENCE OF RUSSIA

CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
LEADERSHIP → Lenin and Trotsky firmer	OPPONENT → Whites divided in aim	LEADERSHIP → Lenin and Trotsky firmer
GEOGRAPHY → central Russian core controlled	INTERVENTION → Reds claim defence of Russia	GEOGRAPHY → central Russian core controlled

CORE CLAIM
- LEADERSHIP → Lenin and Trotsky firmer
- GEOGRAPHY → central Russian core controlled

MECHANISM
- OPPONENT → Whites divided in aim
- INTERVENTION → Reds claim defence of Russia

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- LEADERSHIP → Lenin and Trotsky firmer
- GEOGRAPHY → central Russian core controlled

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: OPPONENT → Whites divided in aim; INTERVENTION → Reds claim defence of Russia.

07

STAGE 07 NEP BOUNDARY

NEP BOUNDARY · MARKET RETURNS · PEASANT SURPLUS AND SMALL TRADE · STATE RETAINS · HEAVY INDUSTRY, BANKS AND TRANSPORT · COMMUNIST MONOPOLY CONTINUES · ECONOMIC RETREAT WITHOUT POLITICAL RETREAT

CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
MARKET RETURNS → peasant surplus and small trade	POLITICS → communist monopoly continues	MARKET RETURNS → peasant surplus and small trade
STATE RETAINS → heavy industry, banks and transport	VERDICT → economic retreat without political retreat	STATE RETAINS → heavy industry, banks and transport

CORE CLAIM
- MARKET RETURNS → peasant surplus and small trade
- STATE RETAINS → heavy industry, banks and transport

MECHANISM
- POLITICS → communist monopoly continues
- VERDICT → economic retreat without political retreat

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- MARKET RETURNS → peasant surplus and small trade
- STATE RETAINS → heavy industry, banks and transport

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: STATE RETAINS → heavy industry, banks and transport.

08

STAGE 08 STALIN'S RISE LADDER

STALIN'S RISE LADDER · GENERAL SECRETARY · ORGANISATIONAL NETWORK · UNDERESTIMATE STALIN · SHIFTING ALLIANCES · TROTSKY ISOLATED FIRST · KAMENEV, ZINOVIEV AND BUKHARIN REMOVED

GENERAL SECRETARY → organisational network → RIVALS → underestimate Stalin → SHIFTING ALLIANCES → Trotsky isolated first → END → Kamenev, Zinoviev and Bukharin removed

CORE CLAIM
- GENERAL SECRETARY → organisational network
- RIVALS → underestimate Stalin

MECHANISM
- SHIFTING ALLIANCES → Trotsky isolated first
- END → Kamenev, Zinoviev and Bukharin removed

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- GENERAL SECRETARY → organisational network
- RIVALS → underestimate Stalin

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: SHIFTING ALLIANCES → Trotsky isolated first; END → Kamenev, Zinoviev and Bukharin removed.

09

STAGE 09 INDUSTRIALISATION AND COLLECTIVISATION

INDUSTRIALISATION AND COLLECTIVISATION · FIVE YEAR PLANS · HEAVY OUTPUT RISES · SCARCITY AND DISCIPLINE PERSIST · GRAIN CONTROL INCREASES · RURAL COST · RESISTANCE, LIVESTOCK LOSS AND FAMINE · CLOSE DISTINCTION

CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
FIVE YEAR PLANS → heavy output rises	COLLECTIVISATION → grain control increases	CLOSE DISTINCTION: February overthrew tsarism and created dual power
CONSUMPTION → scarcity and discipline persist	RURAL COST → resistance, livestock loss and famine	October transferred power to the Bolsheviks, while decrees, coercion and Civil War changed the revolutionary coalition and state.

CORE CLAIM
- FIVE YEAR PLANS → heavy output rises
- CONSUMPTION → scarcity and discipline persist

MECHANISM
- COLLECTIVISATION → grain control increases
- RURAL COST → resistance, livestock loss and famine

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- CLOSE DISTINCTION: February overthrew tsarism and created dual power
- October transferred power to the Bolsheviks, while decrees, coercion and Civil War changed the revolutionary coalition and state.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: CLOSE DISTINCTION: February overthrew tsarism and created dual power; October transferred power to the Bolsheviks, while decrees, coercion and Civil War changed the revolutionary coalition and state.

10

STAGE 10 CONSTITUTION AND TERROR

CONSTITUTION AND TERROR · 1936 CONSTITUTION · DEMOCRATIC APPEARANCE · ONE PARTY · NO REAL ELECTORAL COMPETITION · STALIN BECOMES UNCHALLENGEABLE · CAPABILITY COST · OFFICERS AND OFFICIALS REMOVED

CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
1936 CONSTITUTION → democratic appearance	PURGES → Stalin becomes unchallengeable	EVIDENCE LIMIT: Industrialisation and state capacity must be assessed alongside collectivisation, famine, purges,
ONE PARTY → no real electoral competition	CAPABILITY COST → officers and officials removed	nationality policy and the evidentiary limits of official output or constitutional claims.

CORE CLAIM
- 1936 CONSTITUTION → democratic appearance
- ONE PARTY → no real electoral competition

MECHANISM
- PURGES → Stalin becomes unchallengeable
- CAPABILITY COST → officers and officials removed

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- EVIDENCE LIMIT: Industrialisation and state capacity must be assessed alongside collectivisation, famine, purges,
- nationality policy and the evidentiary limits of official output or constitutional claims.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: EVIDENCE LIMIT: Industrialisation and state capacity must be assessed alongside collectivisation, famine, purges, nationality policy and the evidentiary limits of official output or constitutional claims.

11

STAGE 11 REVOLUTION-TO-STALIN ANSWER SPINE

REVOLUTION-TO-STALIN ANSWER SPINE · UNRESOLVED 1905 ORDER PLUS WAR · DUAL POWER AND ORGANISED OCTOBER · DECREE, COERCION, CIVIL WAR AND NEP · INDUSTRY, COLLECTIVISATION AND TERROR

COLLAPSE → unresolved 1905 order plus war → SEIZURE → dual power and organised October → CONSOLIDATION → decree, coercion, Civil War and NEP → TRANSFORMATION → industry, collectivisation and terror

CORE CLAIM
- COLLAPSE → unresolved 1905 order plus war
- SEIZURE → dual power and organised October

MECHANISM
- CONSOLIDATION → decree, coercion, Civil War and NEP
- TRANSFORMATION → industry, collectivisation and terror

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- COLLAPSE → unresolved 1905 order plus war
- SEIZURE → dual power and organised October

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: CONSOLIDATION → decree, coercion, Civil War and NEP.

E

EXTRA SUBORDINATE ENRICHMENT — ONLY AFTER THE COMPLETE CORE

OPTIONAL ADVANCED ENRICHMENT · GEORGE KATKOV STRESSES ELITE CONSPIRACY AND ABDICATION FROM ABOVE · W. H. CHAMBERLIN STRESSES A LEADERLESS, SPONTANEOUS UPRISING FROM · LATER HISTORIANS HIGHLIGHTED WORKERS' MATERIAL GRIEVANCES MORE THAN PARTY · DISPERSED THE CONSTITUENT ASSEMBLY · JUSTIFIED EXECUTIONS AND COERCION · BANNED FACTIONALISM WITHIN THE PARTY · "SOCIALISM IN ONE COUNTRY" VERSUS "PERMANENT REVOLUTION"

OPTIONAL SOURCE DEPTH
- George Katkov stresses elite conspiracy and abdication from above;
- W. H. Chamberlin stresses a leaderless, spontaneous uprising from below;
- later historians highlighted workers' material grievances more than party direction.
- dispersed the Constituent Assembly;

ADVANCED DEBATE
- justified executions and coercion;
- banned factionalism within the party.
- "socialism in one country" versus "permanent revolution";
- continuation of NEP versus rapid industrialization.

LEGACY / NUANCE
- Robert Conquest offers very high estimates;
- official post-Soviet data suggest lower but still enormous totals;
- Ronald Suny's wider counting pushes the destroyed lives still higher when famine is included.
- "inevitable revolution" is a historiographical question, not a settled factual statement.

OPTIONAL STATUS — This optional depth is unnecessary for a competent core answer; use it only for added nuance after the complete core has been written.

END OF MASTER CANVAS • poster embeds this exact master • tiled pages are overlapping crops of the same pixels